floating towards me containing tequila in every form. Neat. Rocks. Margarita. Splash of soda and lime.

I drank it all, every drop, and started feeling very bloody good.

I thought: I like these Americans. I like them a lot.

Strange time to be pro-American. Most of the world wasn't. Certainly not Britain. Many Brits despised the American war in Afghanistan, and resented being dragged into it. With some the anti-American sentiment ran very hot. I was reminded of my childhood, when people warned me all the time about Americans. Too loud, too rich, too happy. Too confident, too direct, too honest.

Nah, I always thought. Yanks didn't beat about the bush, didn't fill the air with polite snorts and throat clearings before coming to the point. Whatever was on their mind, they'd spit it out, like a sneeze, and while that could be problematic at times, I usually found it preferable to the alternative:

No one saying what they truly felt.

No one wanting to hear how you felt.

I'd experienced that at twelve years old. I experienced it even more now that I was thirty-one.

I floated through that day on a pink cloud of tequila fumes. No—floated is wrong. I *piloted* the pink cloud, and after I landed it—textbook landing, by the way—I woke with no hangover. Miracle.

The next day, or the day after, we moved for some reason. We went from the home of Thomas's girlfriend to the home of Courteney Cox. She was a friend of Thomas's girlfriend, and had more room. Also, she was traveling, on a job, and didn't mind if we crashed at her place.

No complaints from me. As a *Friends* fanatic, the idea of crashing at Monica's was highly appealing. And amusing. But then…Courteney turned up. I was very confused. Was her job canceled? I didn't think it was my place to ask. More: *Does this mean we have to leave?*

She smiled. *Of course not, Harry. Plenty of room.*

Great. But I was still confused because…she was Monica. And I was a Chandler. I wondered if I'd ever work up the courage to tell her. Was there